2 Robert Bruce Foote, *Prehistoric and protohistoric antiquities of India*, 1916.

3 T. J. Newbold, ‘On some ancient mounds of scorious ashes in Southern India’, *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*, Vol. VII, 1843.

4 Raymond Allchin, *Neolithic cattle-keepers in South India: a study of the Deccan mounds*, 1963.

5 D. Q. Fuller, R. Korisettar and P. C. Venkatasubbiah, ‘Southern Neolithic cultivation systems: a reconstruction based on archaeobotanical evidence’, *South Asian Studies*, Vol. 1, 2001.

6 *The Hindu* newspaper, 6 November 2007.

7 Robert Caldwell, *A political and general history of the district of Tinnevelly,* 1881.

8 There are numerous theories as to the origins of the name but I am persuaded by the arguments of the Tamil-born French historian J. B. Prashant More in his book *Origins and Development of Madras*, 2014. Similar arguments rage over the origins of the more recent name Chennai.

9 Samuel Purchas, *Purchas His Pilgrimage, or Relations of the World and the Religions observed in all Ages and Places discovered, from the Creation unto this Present*, 1613.

10 Edgar Thurston, *Castes and Tribes of Southern India*, Vol. III, 1909. Thurston drew on the earlier work of M. Ratnaswami Aiyar, ‘Kanikkars of Travancore’, *Indian Review*, 1902.

11 However, it would be incorrect to state that all these hill-dwellers were among India’s earliest immigrants, as Thurston and his peers believed. Research by Professor Sumit Guha and others has shown that reverse migration also occurred in South India in which later arrivals regressed into the hills in the medieval era. S. Guha, *Environment and ethnicity in India 1200–1991,* 1999.